

Diploma in Leadership & Management

Key principles of Leadership

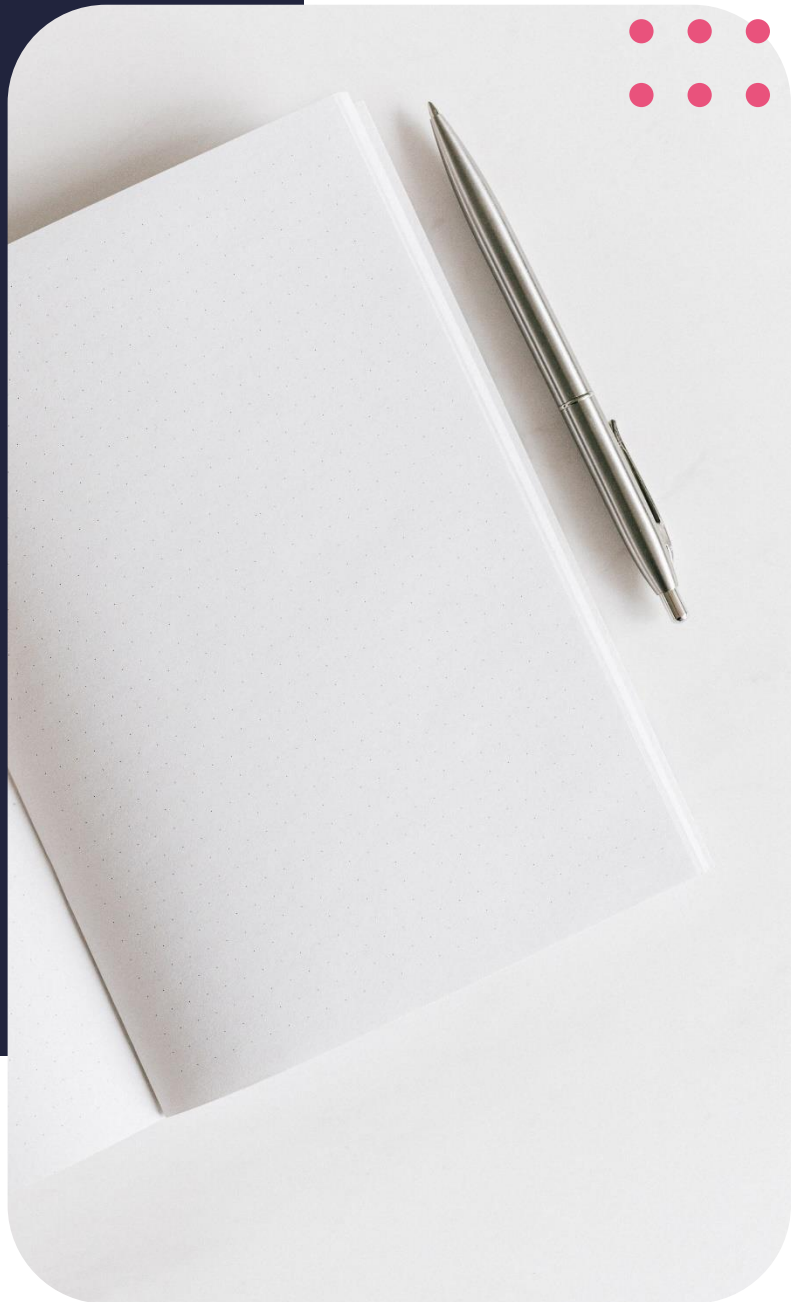
Module 1 Lesson 5

Summary Notes



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Lesson 5 Objectives

- Be respectful
- Build trust
- Be responsible and lead with courage

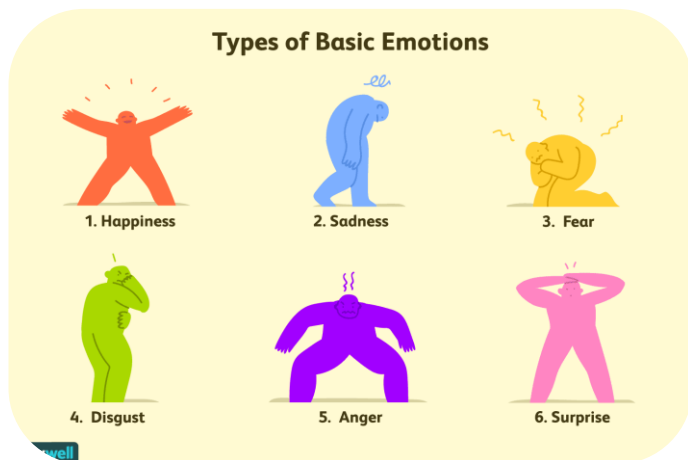
Lesson Introduction

Respect, trust, responsibility and courage will be our building blocks for this lesson. I want to advise that you challenge yourself with this lesson. Be honest when you evaluate yourself and where you need to improve. This is the start to you mastering these skills.

Key Reading Materials

- <https://www.northstarmeetingsgroup.com/Incentive/Strategy/Respectful-leadership-not-micromanagement?inc=1>
 - <https://www.lollydaskal.com/leadership/7-things-the-most-respected-leaders-do-every-day/>
 - <https://www.yourthoughtpartner.com/blog/bid/59619/leaders-follow-these-6-steps-to-build-trust-with-employees-improve-how-you-re-perceived>
 - <http://www.leadership.com.sg/perspective/worldview/leading-with-courage/#.XocARYgzZPY>
 - <https://www.forbes.com/sites/susantardanico/2013/01/15/10-traits-of-courageous-leaders/#3809128b4fc0>
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Top ways to control your emotions as a leader and manager



It can be hard to be a respectful leader, build trust and lead with courage when our emotions get in the way. This can mean that we miss out on opportunities to use these amazing approaches because of a leader or manager being reactive.

According to (Dan, 2019), here are the top ways to better control your emotions:

Learn to respond and not react

This means that you're taking time to process the information before you have your feedback or input. When leaders or managers are too reactive, they can become over-emotional and make bad calls or break down the relationship that they have built up with their employees. If you struggle with this skill, walk away from the situation, process the information and then come back.

Focus on what you can control

Focus on your internal control and avoid focusing on all of the external things you cannot control. For example, you can control the way in which you react but you cannot control the way your boss reacts.

Prioritise

Make sure that you're focusing on the important things first. This means that you're looking at a situation and you know what needs to be done first. Avoid becoming overwhelmed and emotional. Analyse the situation, write down what needs to happen, and come up with a plan.

Be honest with yourself

Know what you can and cannot handle. You can ask for support or help at any point to help you cope with a problem or issue. You don't always have to come up with all the solutions.

Strategies to control your emotions



Analyse the situation

Talk the issue out with someone you trust. You can ask for feedback and problem solve with someone who helps you see it in a neutral way.

Calm down

Take time before speaking or reacting. Calm down before you respond or walk away from the situation before you say the wrong thing.

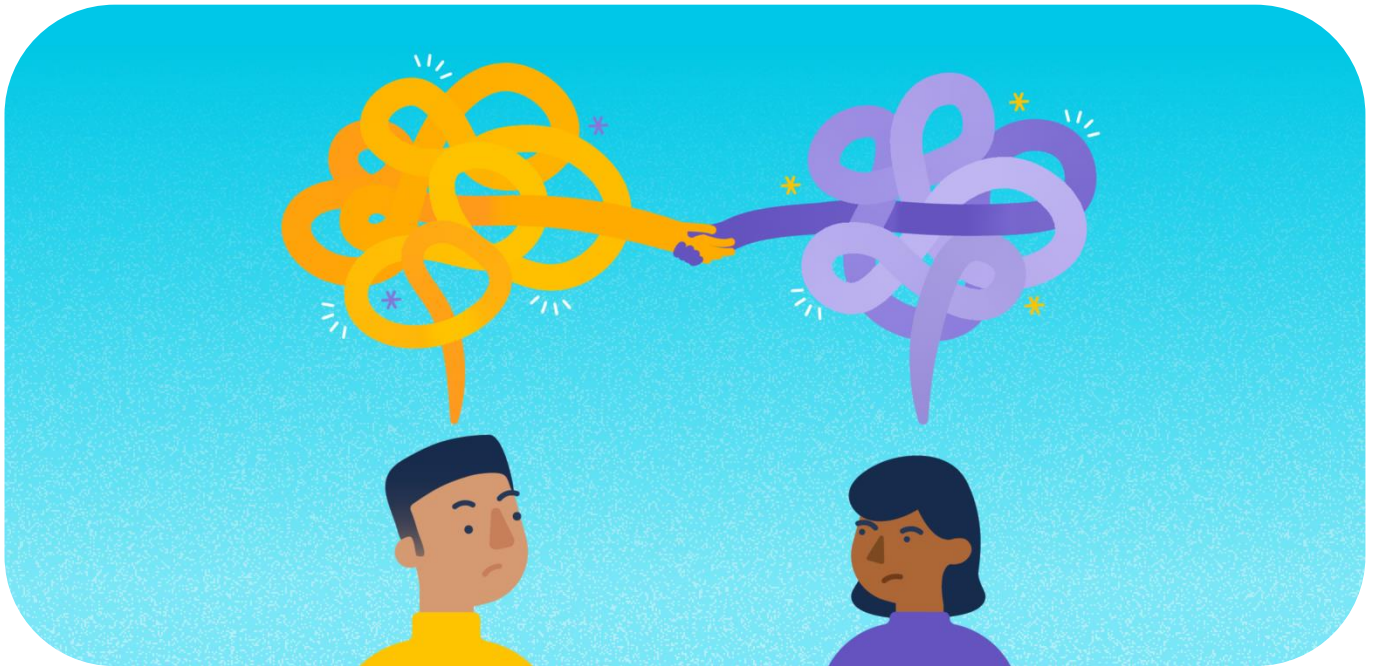
Never bring your emotions home

Avoid bringing those negative emotions home that can impact your personal life. Make sure you leave work things at work. Allow yourself to have a work-life balance.

Never respond when angry

Avoid responding when you're in a state of extreme emotions. For example, don't respond to an email in a time of anger. Wait until you're ready and calm before responding.

Be a respectful leader



According to (Quick Base, 2012), there are several ways that you become a respected leader.

Update your leadership style

This means that leaders and managers have built up the knowledge and experience to understand the different leadership styles. This will help the leader and manager to better apply the approach that their team needs. This is an amazing way to build respect with your team as they feel understood and that their manager and leader is there to support them.

Engage with your team

Build an effective work relationship with your team and team members. They need to know that you're there for them and that you will back them up when needed. Employees don't need a manager or leader that will walk away after a few months or that won't be there when they need you the most.

Earn, don't demand respect

It can take time to gain the respect that you want from your team. Make sure that you're investing the time and effort into your team that they need to truly respect you. Make sure that you're constant, that you're listening and changing for the improvement of your team.

Be transparent

Employees will trust you more when they know you've been honest and open in tough times. Employees are strong enough to handle the truth, they don't need a sugar-coated way of being told information.

Habits of highly respected leaders

According to (Fast Company, 2015), the habits of highly respectful leaders are that:

- You lead by example
 - You are self-aware
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- You always do your best
- You give credit where credit is due
- You take responsibility for your actions
- You are fair with all employees
- You are the same with all employees

Build trust



(St-Aubin & Lavallée-Fortier, 2019) stated that the following are great ways to build trust in the workplace:

- “Trust is a requisite in the workplace so that everyone feels they are there for the right reasons, working toward shared goals with a sense of purpose. Yet, according to our Officevibe data, 19% of employees do not feel that their organisation trusts them to contribute to its mission”.
- “When team members trust one another, they feel safe to share their ideas and thus conflict becomes productive. Trust between employees and their managers leads to improved performance and strengths-based employee development. And ultimately, with a workforce that trusts in your leadership, everyone is better aligned around a shared mission, common goals, and the strategy that will take you there”.

Demonstrate clear vision

Employees want to be part of the bigger picture. They are more likely to trust you as a manager and leader when they know that what they’re doing is part of the bigger picture. They want to know that the leader and manager are leading them to reach the correct objectives.

Offer trust as a default

Give your employees the benefit of the doubt and trust them first. Give them time to express themselves and make decisions. When the trust is broken, then you can address the issue. It's important to give the employee what you expect from them.

Seek feedback

Ask for feedback from your team, manager, or leader. The idea is that you open the communication lines so that you can improve. You can either send out a survey or ask for a one-on-one meeting with the person you're asking feedback from.

Why would you want your employees to trust you?

Better team

You have a better and more effective team because they trust your judgment and they will follow your lead.

Culture shift

Employees will start to trust each other more when there is effective trust in the team, which starts with management.

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St-Aubin, N., & Lavallée-Fortier, S. (2019, December 20). *8 Keys To Building Trust In The Workplace*. Retrieved from Office vibe : <https://officevibe.com/blog/8-secrets-build-trust-leader>